Contact

joshuabaer@capitalfactory.com

www.linkedin.com/in/joshuabaer (LinkedIn)
austinpreneur.com/ (Other)
angel.co/joshuabaer (Other)
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Top Skills

Email Marketing
Online Marketing
Cloud Computing

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)

Honors-Awards

Community Leader of the Year
Austin Under 40 Winner - Technology & Science
Henry Crown Fellow
Torch of Liberty
Braddock Scholar

Joshua Baer

Austinpreneur - I help people quit their jobs and become entrepreneurs.
Austin, Texas, United States

Summary

Joshua Baer helps people quit their jobs and become entrepreneurs. He's the founder of Capital Factory, a startup community that helps entrepreneurs find investors, customers and employees. Josh founded his first startup in 1996 in his college dormitory at Carnegie Mellon University and now teaches a class at the University of Texas for student entrepreneurs. He is a Henry Crown Fellow and Braddock Scholar at the Aspen Institute, a member of the National Committee on US-China Relations Young Leaders Forum, an Eisenhower Fellow, and a recipient of the Anti-Defamation League Torch of Liberty. Josh lives in Austin with his wife Amy and three children. The best way to reach him is on Twitter @joshuabaer or by email josh@quityourjob.com

My Life Strategy:
1. Plant lots of seeds
2. Water everyone's
3. Repeat

"That which you manifest is before you." - The Art of Racing in the Rain

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Experience

Capital Factory
Founder & CEO
January 2009 - Present (17 years 7 months)
Austin, Texas

Capital Factory is the center of gravity for entrepreneurs in Texas, the number one startup state in the U.S. Thousands of entrepreneurs, programmers and designers gather day and night, in-person and online for meetups, classes and coworking. With boots on the ground in Austin, Dallas and Houston, we meet the best entrepreneurs in Texas and introduce them to their first investors,

employees, mentors and customers. According to Pitchbook, Capital Factory has been the most active investor in Texas since 2010.

http://www.capitalfactory.com

Eisenhower Fellowships
Eisenhower Fellow
October 2014 - Present (11 years 10 months)

Eisenhower Fellowships is a private, non-profit, non-partisan organization seeking to foster international understanding and leadership through the exchange of information, ideas and perspectives among leaders throughout the world. Established in 1953 as a birthday tribute to President Dwight D. Eisenhower, the organization has sponsored more than 2,000 Fellows from 108 countries. For more information, visit www.efworld.org

The Aspen Institute
Henry Crown Fellow
March 2013 - Present (13 years 5 months)

The Henry Crown Fellowship Program, established in 1997, seeks to develop the next generation of community-spirited leaders, providing them with the tools necessary to meet the challenges of business and civic leadership in the 21st century. The program is a unique mix of seminars designed to broaden the perspectives of the participants and hone their skills in values-centered leadership. It honors the memory of Chicago industrialist Henry Crown (1896-1990), whose legendary career was marked by a lifelong commitment to honor, integrity, industry and philanthropy.

I'm in the 2013 (XVII) class.

Austin Startup Week
Founder & Organizer
August 2011 - Present (15 years)

Started in 2011, Austin Startup Week is five days of events celebrating Austin startups, the organizations and meetups that support them and all the awesome people that make them happen!

Each year, organizations and startups open their doors, put on events and roll out the red carpet for both locals and visitors alike who are interested in learning more about the startup scene in Austin.

University of Texas at Austin
Entrepreneur in Residence, Computer Science Department
May 2011 - Present (15 years 3 months)
Austin, Texas

I teach the Longhorn Startup Seminar and Lab along with Bob Metcalfe and Ben Dyer. Our students get credit for graduation for working on their own startups along with help from mentors in the Austin community. http://longhornstartup.com

Capital Thought
Managing Partner
March 2004 - Present (22 years 5 months)

Startup studio founded with Jason Cohen and Bill Boebel. Helped create Bazaarvoice, Rackspace Cloud and WP Engine.

National Committee on U.S.-China Relations
Young Leaders Forum
September 2014 - Present (11 years 11 months)
Yangzhou, Jiangsu, China

The Young Leaders Forum (YLF), now in its second decade, provides opportunities that will enhance the dialogue between our countries and build lasting ties between our peoples. Each year, YLF holds a 3½-day retreat to which a select group of exceptional American and Chinese young professionals are invited. Together, participants explore substantive issues and develop enduring friendships in a casual, intimate environment.

Pingboard
Board of Directors
November 2013 - December 2023 (10 years 2 months)

Pingboard is a modern, social company directory. We make heroes out of Office Managers and provide a simple, extendable API to your employees.

I helped Bill Boebel found this company and spin it out of Capital Thought.

Startup Games
Board of Directors
January 2014 - March 2020 (6 years 3 months)

Startup Games unites high-growth tech companies in friendly competition to build great cultures while giving back to their local communities. Our vision is to have the top 20 startup communities in the world compete in an Olympics-

style event crowning an annual world champion, with the goal of raising $1,000,000 per year for charity.

The Games: 16 tech startups compete in ten events for a day of networking, fun and philanthropy. Each company plays for the charity of their choice, and at the end of the event, every charity walks away with money for their organization, with the largest portion of the pot going to 1st, 2nd and 3rd place teams.

Find out how to bring the Startup Games to your city at http://startupgames.com

PostUp
Founder & Board of Directors
April 2014 - April 2019 (5 years 1 month)
austin, texas

We deliver email. Lots of it.

Formerly known as SKYLIST, PulseConnect, and PostUp. Sold to Upland Software in 2019.

Texas Tribune
Board of Directors
September 2015 - October 2017 (2 years 2 months)
Austin, Texas Area

The Texas Tribune is the only member-supported, digital-first, nonpartisan media organization that informs Texans — and engages with them — about public policy, politics, government and statewide issues.

WP Engine
Board of Directors
January 2010 - October 2017 (7 years 10 months)
Austin, Texas Area

WP Engine provides the fastest, most secure Wordpress hosting along with the best customer service. Plus custom tools you won't find anywhere else like a staging server, backups to github, and more.

If your Wordpress site is important, it should be hosted on WP Engine. http://wpengine.com

I helped Jason Cohen found this company and spin it out of Capital Thought.

Greater Austin Chamber of Commerce
Board of Directors
January 2014 - December 2015 (2 years)
Austin, Texas

Return Path
Fellow
January 2012 - December 2015 (4 years)
Austin, Texas

Return Path helps generate actionable data from email.

I founded OtherInbox, the app store for your Inbox.

I led the acquisition of Context.io, the missing API for email.

Inbox Love
Founder & Organizer
November 2010 - October 2015 (5 years)

A one day conference focused on the Future of Email. Must-know tactics and latest updates on email platforms & tech innovation solutions. Proven techniques for rocking customer acquisition, retention & deliverability, as well as deal flow for partnership and acquisition channels.New email productivity & workflow solutions for the busy professional.

Leadership Austin
2014 Essentials Class
September 2014 - June 2015 (10 months)

I'm a member of the 2014 Leadership Austin Essentials Class, connecting me with 60 other Austin leaders and guiding us through an exploration of how the City of Austin works and what challenges lie ahead.

Greenling Organic Delivery
Board of Directors
December 2006 - September 2014 (7 years 10 months)

Greenling Organic Delivery provides home delivery of local and organic grocery items directly to your home. For the same price as whole foods, you can have high quality organic goodies brought to your door. This award winning startup is currently servicing the Austin and San Antonio markets and expanding rapidly.

As an investor and board member, I help Greenling with their eCommerce website and online marketing strategy, as well as fundraising and corporate strategy.

Ignite Austin
Founder & Organizer
January 2010 - March 2014 (4 years 3 months)

5 minutes. 20 slides. What would you say?

Ignite Austin brings together an inspiring and unexpected blend of thinkers from business, art, technology, government and academia. All with ideas. And all willing to share them.

I'm fortunate to work with Whurley, Josh Jones-Dilworth, John Rodriguez and my wife Amy Baer as co-organizers on this.

http://www.igniteaustin.org

Deliverability.com
Publisher
November 2003 - January 2014 (10 years 3 months)
Austin, Texas

Deliverability.com is the premier independent blog for the email marketing community. Tens of thousands of readers come here to find news, rumors and tips about email deliverability and email marketing posted by a dozen of the leaders in the industry.

OtherInbox
Founder & CEO
January 2008 - January 2013 (5 years 1 month)
Austin, Texas

I founded OtherInbox in 2008 with Mike Subelsky. We launched at TechCrunch50 and then at the SXSW Accelerator. At the end of 2011 we joined Return Path and I continue as CEO of OtherInbox.

OtherInbox saves you time and cuts down on unwanted emails. You don't have to learn anything new or change your email address - we work with what you've got. More than 2 million people think that their Aol, Gmail or Yahoo Mail inbox is better with OtherInbox. Automatic Organizer cleans up your inbox by putting receipts, newsletters, and Facebook messages into folders. Every

morning you get a daily summary to make sure that you don't miss anything important. When you get a shipping notice, it automatically shows up on your calendar in Outlook or Google Calendar. Unsubscriber is the simplest way to stop emails you don't want. Just put the messages that you don't want into the Unsubscribe folder and forget about them. Unsubscriber will make sure that you don't ever see any messages from them again, plus it will actually try to click the links and get you off the list. OtherInbox, Inc. is proudly based in Austin, Texas and is a wholly-owned subsidiary of Return Path, Inc.

BUZZMGR

Founder & Advisor

June 2004 - December 2012 (8 years 7 months)

Created the technical direction, direct development resources and overall leadership for BUZZMGR. The service monitors and anlyzes online word of mouth in fan-generated media such as social networks, blogs, fan forums and influence the buzz in sports, entertainment and lifestyle markets for PR and marketing purposes.

Datran Media

5 years 5 months

Chief Evangelist

December 2007 - May 2011 (3 years 6 months)

I work with emerging media, press and corporate development.

Chief Technology Officer

January 2006 - January 2008 (2 years 1 month)

Datran served optimized, relevant and custom created advertisements into your email inbox, like an ad server. Like paid search, performance dictates which ads float to the top and which sink to the bottom. In 2011 Datran Media merged with ContextWeb to form PulsePoint.

I became Chief Technology Officer of Datran Media in January 2006 after it acquired SKYLIST and UnsubCentral. I was an executive sponsor for key strategic accounts including Microsoft and Turner, lead R&D projects across the companies, and represented Datran Media to the industry and the press.

Lashback

Board of Directors

July 2005 - January 2010 (4 years 7 months)

Formed in 2003, LashBack was born from the idea that someone should be able to automate an email unsubscribe request. Since then LashBack has developed and patented several 2nd generation anti-spam technologies which are being adopted by the largest ISPs in the world to enhance their spam fighting abilities. LashBack's unsubscribe "Reputation" services and automated unsubscribe service "UnsubSafe" will play a key role in stamping out the burden of junk email to ISP's anti-spam organizations and their consumers.

LashBack is raising the value of email by developing and deploying technical solutions that bring visibility, accountability and control to all players in the email Ecosystem. Currently LashBack data is used to protect over 500 million inboxes worldwide.

Email Senders and Providers Coalition (ESPC)
Committee Chair
January 2004 - December 2008 (5 years)

The Email Sender and Provider Coalition (ESPC) was formed to fight spam while protecting the delivery of legitimate email. The ESPC members have recognized the need for strong spam solutions that ensure the delivery of legitimate email and have been very active in the war against spam.

I founded and co-chaired the Vendor Relations committee (which later was renamed the Receiver Relations committee) and currently co-chair the Technology committee.

http://www.espcoalition.org/
http://www.deliverability.com/

Hoop-a-paluza
Board of Advisors
October 2007 - September 2008 (1 year)

Hoop-A-Paluza (HAPI) is a charity, a fundraiser and a big party all rolled into one. We hold an annual carnival each year. People register for the event online. Before the event, participants obtain pledges from donors who "sponsor" them to shoot 20 free throws. At the event, participants shoot their baskets to raise money for worthy children’s causes, after which they and their families enjoy rides, free refreshments, entertainment and fun contests. All proceeds benefit a select group of children's charities each year – and

participants and their families enjoy a fun-filled carnival-style event free of charge.

With an all-volunteer organization since its founding in 2002, HAPI has raised more than $1,000,000 to aid children's causes in New Jersey and spawned sister events around the country.

Charity Partners of Austin
Board of Directors
May 2006 - April 2008 (2 years)

CPA was founded in 2005 by a group of local philanthropists with the objective of giving back to our community, while producing fun and entertaining events for families and friends. We focus on providing funding support for nonprofit organizations that have a direct and meaningful impact on kids, families, and the arts.
http://www.charitypartnersofaustin.org/

ME Television
Board of Advisors
April 2006 - April 2008 (2 years 1 month)

ME, "Music and Entertainment" Television, is a 24- hour regional network dedicated to showcasing and providing television exposure for regional artists as well as the hundreds of touring groups that make up the vibrant Texas live music scene. Supporting established artists and promoting and discovering new talent is a priority. ME is the entertainment resource, with venue schedules, artist information, interviews and local live music shows every night at 7pm on ME Live!

ME Television launched October 1, 2005 and is currently broadcast to Austin and the 40 surrounding cities. ME Television is a national prototype for a series of regional music and entertainment networks around the country.

Besides hanging around the TV studio every chance I get, I also help out with the Internet strategy.

http://www.metelevision.com/

EFF Austin
Board of Directors
September 2006 - November 2007 (1 year 3 months)

The Electronic Frontier Foundation Austin advocates establishment and protection of digital rights and defense of the wealth of digital information, innovation, and technology. We promote the right of all citizens to communicate and share information without unreasonable constraint. We also advocate the fundamental right to explore, tinker, create, and innovate along the frontier of emerging technologies.
http://www.effaustin.org/

UnsubCentral
Founder & CEO
January 2004 - January 2006 (2 years 1 month)

In December 2003 Congress passed the CAN-SPAM act. It made the advertiser responsible for honoring unsubscribes and maintaining an email suppression list, which many had never done before. In order to comply with the law, email marketers now needed to securely exchange these suppression files.

We launched UnsubCentral in January 2004 to provide a secure, central repository for email suppression lists and easy access control. It quickly became the gold standard for email suppression lists and provides trusted, third party compliance for billions of email messages per month.

Ferris Research
Guest Analyst
May 1997 - January 2006 (8 years 9 months)

I started out working with David Ferris in college as a contract programmer for his Filemaker Pro database and website. Soon I became a guest analyst, writing and reviewing research notes on emerging technology, regulation, and best practices for distribution to F500 CTO / CIO client base.

SKYLIST, Inc.
Founder & CEO
January 1996 - December 2005 (10 years)

I started SKYLIST as a dorm-room dot-com while studying at Carnegie Mellon. I was working with ListSTAR as an intern at StarNine and one of my consulting clients asked me if I would host the Computer Book Publishing discussion list on my server. One list became two, and then ten, and then a hundred.

By the time I graduated from CMU, I had a nice little business with a few hundred thousand a year in revenue. But it was when we decided to take the

plunge and create our own email platform called StormPost that the company really started to grow quickly. We also shifted focus from discussion forums to newsletters and promotions.

By the time I sold SKYLIST to Datran Media, it was ranked best value by Jupiter research and had earned clients such as Microsoft, Nascar, Disney and the Boston Globe.

In 2006, SKYLIST was rated one of the best places to work in Austin.

Datran Media became PulsePoint and then eventually SKYLIST and UnsubCentral spun out of PulsePoint and rebranded as PostUp, where I am now an independent board member.

URaPI
Founder & CTO
May 2001 - January 2005 (3 years 9 months)

Netmonitor, Inc.
Founder & CEO
January 2000 - January 2005 (5 years 1 month)

VentureBeginnings
Entrepreneur in Residence
September 1999 - January 2001 (1 year 5 months)

VentureBeginnings was an Pittsburgh incubator run by RF Culbertson and focused on the students coming out of Carnegie Mellon.

IveBeenGood.com
Director of Business Development
October 1999 - August 2000 (11 months)

IveBeenGood.com was incubated in Trilogy University and also operated as UberWorks, Inc.

We launched at Internet World 1999 and were covered on the CBS Evening News and New York Times.
http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gz39wHj95c
http://query.nytimes.com/gst/fullpage.html?res=9901E0DC1E3DF93BA25752C1A96F958260

I was a key contributor from product conception to company acquisition for $20mm by Network Commerce. I developed the sales pitch and strategy for > $1M software licensing and hosting deals, opened the initial pipeline, closed $2mm+ in revenue in 6 months, and developed and executed $250,000 online marketing plan with <$3 customer acquisition cost.

Trilogy Software
Trilogy University
July 1999 - September 1999 (3 months)

TU is a three to four month total-immersion program that many view as the most challenging and most rewarding period of their career.

Each TU class is tasked with using innovation and technology to drive the execution of Trilogy's strategy. Previous TU classes have built new products and even new businesses. Others have driven Trilogy’s focus on e-commerce. A TU project in 1999 became one of our largest software deals of the year. As the company intensified its focus on leadership development the next year, a TU team created a web site that the company still uses today to communicate our vision and exchange ideas that drive forward every day.

Recognized in a case study for Harvard Business School and described in an article in the Harvard Business Review magazine, TU is a program in which young professionals are proud to have participated.

Here is an article from Fortune in 1998 that talks about life at Trilogy back then...
http://www.fastcompany.com/magazine/21/insanity.html

ListMom-Talk
Moderator
January 1996 - June 1999 (3 years 6 months)

ListMom-Talk was an email list of almost 1,000 people who were responsible for running email lists on all platforms. Administrators from the biggest mailing list sites and the developers of mailing list software such were all active on the list. List etiquette, comparisons of list software, problems with members of a list, and listserver configuration were all appropriate topics. The List-Unsubscribe header and the rest of RFC 2369 were developed by this group and is now widely implemented by Microsoft, Google, Yahoo, LISTSERV, Majordomo and pretty much everyone else.

http://www.faqs.org/rfcs/rfc2369.html

StarNine Technologies
Intern
April 1995 - May 1997 (2 years 2 months)

My first real job other than bagging groceries, I was hired by Tom Biddulph to respond to ListSTAR customers on public forums and develop AppleScript extensions. This is when I first started to learn about email.

DeMoulas Market Basket
Grocery Bagger
1992 - 1993 (1 year)

I worked after school at the store on Amherst Road in Nashua, NH.

Education

Carnegie Mellon University
Computer Science & Information Decision Systems, Computer Science · (1994 - 1999)